

# ■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Thursday, August 13, 2026

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## TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

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### THE LIST (5 stories)

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#### ■ **CIA doubted the Iran threat that moved Trump's plane**

***The Angle:** Intelligence agencies disagreed on whether Trump was actually in danger during his Turkey visit last week—raising questions about how seriously to take Israeli warnings and how much the President's security team is second-guessing their own calls.*

- CIA had 'low confidence' in an Iranian assassination threat against **President Trump** that came from **Israeli intelligence**
- The threat prompted an **extraordinary secret flight** where **Trump switched planes** in Turkey
- **U.S. intelligence officials** were **skeptical** of the threat despite it triggering a major security maneuver

#### **The Trust Question**

- If the CIA didn't really buy the threat, why did Trump's team act like it was real—and what does that say about how much we should trust these intelligence calls?

The Washington Post (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL:

<https://www.washingtonpost.com/national-security/2026/08/12/cia-had-low-confidence-iranian-threat-before-trump-switched-planes-turkey/>

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#### ■■ **World just hit a renewable energy milestone nobody's talking about**

***The Angle:** Solar power just crossed 3 terawatts of capacity globally—a genuine turning point in how humanity generates electricity. It's a huge climate story that got buried under the usual noise, and it actually affects energy costs and grid stability where you live.*

- **Global solar capacity hit 3 terawatts** for the first time in human history
- This represents a massive acceleration in renewable energy deployment over the past decade
- Solar is now outpacing coal and natural gas as the fastest-growing energy source worldwide

#### **The Reality Check**

- Why didn't we hear more about this? And what does 3 terawatts actually mean for your electricity bill and the grid?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://eciks.org/20580-solar-panels-3-terawatts-global-milestone>

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#### ■ **New RSV vaccine cuts newborn ICU admissions in half**

***The Angle:** A maternal RSV vaccine rolled out last year is showing remarkable real-world results—50% fewer babies ending up in intensive care. This is a genuine public health win that's flying under the radar while parents deal with the constant threat of respiratory illness in infants.*

- **50% drop** in newborn ICU admissions during the **first full year** of the RSV maternal vaccine program
- RSV (respiratory syncytial virus) is a leading cause of hospitalization in infants under one year old
- The vaccine is administered to pregnant women, providing passive immunity to newborns at birth

#### **The Parent Reality Check**

- If you've got a newborn or remember those early months—have you heard about this RSV vaccine, and would you get it?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: [https://www.gov.uk/government/news/newborn-icu-admissions-drop-50-in-first-full-year-of-rsv-maternal-vaccine-programme?fbclid=IwY2xjawTq-Z9wZG9mAWV4dG4DYWVtAjEwAGJyaWQRMENSrGVNbFFQa0x2ckU0eEFzcnRjBmFwcF9pZBAyMjIwMzIxNzg4MjAwODkyAAEeVmcQ68\\_deKKfkTZEcYKcbej\\_28\\_VYOoLdVxQwVpj8KiSoMKe1WlxdQoG99M\\_aem\\_72F2qNgNPieF6a0k\\_5DDNA](https://www.gov.uk/government/news/newborn-icu-admissions-drop-50-in-first-full-year-of-rsv-maternal-vaccine-programme?fbclid=IwY2xjawTq-Z9wZG9mAWV4dG4DYWVtAjEwAGJyaWQRMENSrGVNbFFQa0x2ckU0eEFzcnRjBmFwcF9pZBAyMjIwMzIxNzg4MjAwODkyAAEeVmcQ68_deKKfkTZEcYKcbej_28_VYOoLdVxQwVpj8KiSoMKe1WlxdQoG99M_aem_72F2qNgNPieF6a0k_5DDNA)

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## ■ **PBS lost 70 years of TV history to a defunct cloud company**

**The Angle:** A major public broadcaster just lost access to 50 terabytes of irreplaceable archival footage—including decades of iconic programming—because their cloud storage vendor went belly-up without warning. It's a cautionary tale about depending on third parties with your most valuable digital assets, and it raises real questions about how institutions should be backing up their history.

- **PBS** lost access to **50 terabytes** of archived content spanning **70 years** of television history
- The data became inaccessible after their contracted **cloud storage vendor went defunct**
- The loss includes what appears to be significant portions of the broadcaster's archival programming library

### **The Backup Reality Check**

- If a major institution like PBS can lose decades of content to a vendor failure, what's actually backing up \*your\* irreplaceable photos and files?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.tomshardware.com/software/cloud-storage/nine-pbs-loses-access-to-70-years-of-data-after-contracted-cloud-storage-vendor-goes-defunct-public-tv-channel-sues-iron-mountain-data-center-which-hosts-archival-materials-to-ensure-preservation>

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## ■ **Nvidia chips show up inside Russian missiles, Ukraine claims**

**The Angle:** Ukraine's military is claiming it found advanced Nvidia AI processors in a Russian missile—raising huge questions about how Moscow is getting cutting-edge U.S. tech despite strict export controls, and whether Silicon Valley's safeguards are actually working.

- **Ukraine** claims to have discovered **Nvidia AI chips** inside a **Russian missile**
- The discovery highlights potential gaps in **U.S. export controls** on advanced semiconductors to Russia
- Nvidia has faced ongoing scrutiny over whether its products are reaching sanctioned countries through third-party channels

### **The Policy Puzzle**

- If a U.S. company's chips are ending up in Russian weapons, who's responsible—the tech company, the government, or the middlemen finding workarounds?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.kyivpost.com/post/82225>

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## TRENDING TODAY

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## ■ **Canadians now paying more in taxes than groceries and rent combined**

**The Angle:** A new study claims Canadian tax bills have officially outpaced spending on food, housing, and utilities—raising questions about whether the tax burden has finally hit a breaking point for ordinary households across the country.

- Study finds **Canadian tax burden exceeded basic necessities spending in 2025**
- Compares **total taxes paid** (federal, provincial, local) against combined costs of **food, shelter, and utilities**
- Highlights growing debate over **cost-of-living crunch** and tax competitiveness in Canada

### **The Wallet Check**

- Do you feel it—or does this study miss something about how your actual money breaks down month to month?

### **ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: Quick Math** - 30 seconds -> Hosts grab a rough household budget: taxes, rent/mortgage, groceries, utilities. Ballpark the numbers on air and see if the study tracks with their own finances.

- **Step 2: Caller Reality Check** - Next 5-7 minutes -> Open lines: 'Where does your tax hit you hardest—income, property, sales tax, all of it?' Get 2-3 callers from different provinces to compare actual breakdowns.

- **Step 3: The Takeaway** - Closing -> Hosts frame whether this is a messaging problem (people don't realize what they're paying) or a real problem (system needs fixing).

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://torontosun.com/news/canadians-spend-more-on-taxes-than-basic-necessities-2025-study>

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## LIFESTYLE CHAT

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### ■ **Jon Hamm's old 'terrible father' quote haunts him as he becomes a dad**

**The Angle:** *The Mad Men* star is about to become a parent at 55—but there's a resurfaced interview where he flat-out said he'd be a terrible father. It's that perfect collision of fate and awkward timing that gets people talking.

- **Jon Hamm** is set to become a dad at **age 55**
- In a resurfaced interview, **Hamm said he'd be a 'terrible father'**
- He was dating **Jennifer Westfeldt** at the time of the old interview—they were together for **18 years**

#### **The Predictions Flip**

- Have you ever said you'd be terrible at something and then ended up actually doing it—for real? We're calling it the Jon Hamm Reversal.

#### **ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN**

- **Step 1: The Old Quote Breakdown** - First segment -> Hosts read the old 'terrible father' quote and unpack what he actually said—was he joking, was it genuine concern, or just pre-parent anxiety talking?

- **Step 2: The Prediction vs. Reality Phone Line** - Mid-segment engagement -> Open the lines: 'Have you ever said you'd suck at parenting, then became a parent anyway? Did you prove yourself wrong?' Let callers share their own flipped predictions.

- **Step 3: Co-Host Hot Take** - Closer -> Hosts debate: Is saying 'I'd be a terrible parent' actually a sign someone *\*will\** be thoughtful and careful with their kids—because at least they're thinking about it?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://pagesix.com/2026/08/13/celebrity-news/jon-hamm-once-said-hed-be-a-terrible-father-in-resurfaced-interview/>

Backup options:

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### ■ **Why men stay silent about domestic violence**

**The Angle:** *New research breaks down a major blind spot: men experiencing intimate partner violence often don't reach out for help—and the reasons are surprisingly consistent. It's a conversation that challenges how we talk about abuse and support.*

- Men are **less likely than women** to seek help after experiencing intimate partner violence
- Key barriers include viewing abuse as a **private matter**
- Men cite **fear of retaliation, shame**, and concerns about **not being believed** as reasons for staying silent
- Research highlights a gap in support systems and cultural attitudes around male victims

#### **The Stigma Shift**

- Do you think we talk about male victims of domestic violence the same way we talk about female victims—and should we?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://publichealth.gmu.edu/news/2026-08/shame-stigma-and-culture-prevent-male-intimate-partner-violence-survivors-seeking-help>

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### ■ **Short sprint beats long jog—here's the science why**

**The Angle:** New research is flipping the script on cardio: a few minutes of all-out sprinting triggers way more metabolic changes than 90 minutes of steady running. It's the kind of finding that makes weekend warriors wonder if they've been doing cardio wrong the whole time.

- Sprinting triggers changes in **more than 200 metabolites**—far more than moderate running does
- An immediate surge of **proteins involved in blood-vessel growth, tissue remodeling, and hormonal signaling** kicks in after sprinting
- The research suggests **short, intense bursts** may deliver bigger physiological payoffs than **90 minutes of moderate-intensity exercise**

#### The Fitness Plot Twist

- Are you ready to ditch the treadmill for five minutes of sprinting, or do you need more convincing that intensity beats duration?

#### ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Challenge Reveal** - Opening beat -> Host A reads the finding cold—'90 minutes of jogging vs. five minutes of sprinting'—and asks Host B to guess which one wins. Let them riff on the conventional wisdom they've always heard.

- **Step 2: The Science Breakdown** - Mid-segment -> Host A explains the metabolite surge and protein activation in plain English—make it visceral ('your body goes into repair mode immediately'). Host B reacts like a listener might ('wait, so I've been wasting my time?').

- **Step 3: The Real-World Test** - Call-in or social engagement -> Ask listeners: 'Have you tried sprint training? Did it actually work, or is this lab stuff that doesn't translate to real life?' Lean into the skeptics and the true believers.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.eurekalert.org/news-releases/1139915>

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## CLOSER: THROWBACK THURSDAY

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### ■ Chip and Joanna Gaines reunite for rare magazine cover moment

**The Angle:** The Magnolia power couple—who've largely kept their personal lives private in recent years—stepped back into the spotlight together to mark a decade of their design and lifestyle journal, giving fans a rare glimpse at the partnership behind the brand.

- **Chip and Joanna Gaines** made a rare joint appearance for the cover of **Magnolia Journal's 10th anniversary issue**
- The couple has become known for keeping their personal life relatively private despite their massive brand presence
- **Magnolia Journal** is the lifestyle publication tied to their **Magnolia empire**, which spans design, home renovation, and media

#### The Nostalgia Play

- Are you still watching Fixer Upper, or did the Gaines lose you somewhere between the home renovation boom and the cookbook empire?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 69/90 (40 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> STRONG

URL: <https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiAwAFBVV95cUxNSE42MmxHdINFMVVzQ3BPRFFvaUM2NGFIMHE5a2w4eWF0MEFHwJmWYjBBdW4wY1lIdnM0eDVQcEtyTDVJZDdRZzI1a1R3VGF6dTVKdXBFNndQZEtkZWhrZnJlLVJkNU5tYVBiIT1NoY1h6Z2k0YS0xMnJ6cVlDcWVSUkJTRFJTJHVZSW9WY19Gb0lrNGI1NE05RWlZUm9pZFh4WG12dmFTZnpGQ0tSbHl6LTNELTQwN2F1cDgzR1ZOSVM?oc=5>

Backup options:

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### ■ Russell Westbrook calls time on an 18-year NBA legend run

**The Angle:** One of the league's most explosive and polarizing superstars—a triple-double machine and 2017 MVP—is hanging it up. Westbrook's retirement marks the end of an era for a guy who played the game like nobody else, and his farewell drop with Michael B. Jordan narrating it is peak Hollywood drama.

- **Russell Westbrook** is retiring after **18 seasons**, making the announcement Wednesday via social media

- He's the NBA's all-time leader in **triple-doubles** and won **MVP in 2017**
- **Two-time scoring champion** who was selected to the NBA's **75th anniversary team**
- His retirement video was **narrated by Michael B. Jordan**

#### The Debate Starter

- Was Westbrook a transcendent talent or a stat-padder who couldn't win when it mattered? Call in—this one divides the fanbase.

Associated Press (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 68/90 (40 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> STRONG

URL: <https://apnews.com/article/nba-kings-russell-westbrook-retires-4c86c3c003efd958dd57883f2223c12a>

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## FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/8 this month; TECH TALK 2/4 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

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## ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

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■ **Kentucky's wild elk herd has grown to more than 10,000 animals across a 16 county restoration zone, the largest elk population east of the Mississippi, more than a century after elk were wiped out in the region.**

*The Angle:* Kentucky's wild elk herd has grown to more than 10,000 animals across a 16 county restoration zone, the largest elk population east of the Mississippi, more than a century after elk were wiped out in the region.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://news.mongabay.com/short-article/2026/08/wildlife-in-the-eastern-u-s-are-making-a-comeback/>

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■ **Conor McGregor credits Brad Pitt for ending his sobriety**

*The Angle:* The UFC star just announced he's drinking again—and says a chance encounter with Brad Pitt inspired the whole thing. It's the kind of random celebrity-collides-with-athlete moment that feels too weird to be real, but here we are.

- **Conor McGregor** announced he's ending his sobriety
- McGregor claims **Brad Pitt** inspired the decision
- McGregor quoted Pitt as saying '**Take it easy, Brad!**' in the announcement

#### The Plot Twist

- If Brad Pitt casually talked you into ending sobriety, would you actually do it—or is McGregor just messing with us?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.operationsports.com/conor-mcgregor-announces-he-is-ending-his-sobriety-and-brad-pitt-inspired-him-to-drink-again-take-it-easy-brad/>

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■ **A boat operator used a foghorn to wake a sleeping polar bear. They were fined over \$5,000.**

*The Angle:* A boat operator used a foghorn to wake a sleeping polar bear. They were fined over \$5,000.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.cbsnews.com/news/sleeping-polar-bear-woken-foghorn-fine-arctic/>

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## ■ Texas Guy Lands in Jail for Dropping the F-Bomb at City Hall

**The Angle:** A Texas man found out the hard way that free speech has limits when he got arrested for swearing during public comment at a government meeting. It's a classic clash between First Amendment rights and what counts as "disorderly conduct."

- A Texas man was jailed after **swearing at a public meeting**
- The arrest raises questions about whether **profanity during public comment** violates free-speech protections
- Local governments often invoke "**disorderly conduct**" charges in these situations, though courts have frequently sided with speakers

### The First Amendment Question

- Should you be able to swear at a city council meeting without getting arrested—or is that where the line should be drawn?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.chron.com/texas/article/tarrant-county-commissioners-court-arrest-22385573.php>

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## ■ DC rush hour brought to a halt by... an adult device

**The Angle:** A bizarre traffic incident in Washington DC that sounds like it came straight from a comedy sketch actually happened — and it shut down a major commute. The absurdity is exactly the kind of 'only in DC' moment that makes for a perfect palate-cleanser heading into the show's final segment.

- A traffic incident in **Washington DC** during **rush hour** was caused by an **adult device** that ended up in the roadway
- The incident was significant enough to cause a **traffic shutdown** or major delay
- The story gained traction on **Reddit's r/nottheonion** community, which specializes in bizarre real-world stories that sound too absurd to be true

### The Laugh-Out-Loud Closer

- Have you ever seen something so ridiculous on the road that you couldn't believe it actually happened — and did you have to explain it to your carpool?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.wusa9.com/article/news/crime/sex-toy-suspicious-package-dc-fire-station-tenleytown/65-a08022da-f17b-4710-8329-579d34e84e35>

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## ■ British politician's opponent literally wears a giant fake head

**The Angle:** A UK special election just became the weirdest political theater in recent memory—Nigel Farage's challenger is a comedic character who shows up in costume. It's real politics colliding with deliberate absurdity, and it says something about how fed up voters are getting.

- **Nigel Farage** is facing off against **Count Binface**, a satirical character known for theatrical political stunts
- The election has been **widely denounced as a stunt** by more serious political observers
- This is a **special election**, suggesting a seat became vacant unexpectedly

### The Absurdity Check

- Is voting for a guy in a giant fake head actually a protest vote against the whole system, or just a laugh?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:

<https://www.pbs.org/newshour/politics/nigel-farage-faces-off-against-count-binface-in-special-election-thats-been-denounced-as-a-stunt>

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## ■ Discord raises free upload limit to 20MB after lowering it two years ago because "storage management is expensive"

**The Angle:** Discord raises free upload limit to 20MB after lowering it two years ago because "storage management is expensive"

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.dexerto.com/entertainment/discord-raises-free-upload-limit-to-20mb-after-lowering-it-two-years-ago-3398251/>

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### ■ **Claude's new Scarlet Letter watermark is invisible — for now**

**The Angle:** *Claude's new Scarlet Letter watermark is invisible — for now*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://arstechnica.com/tech-policy/2026/08/claudes-new-scarlet-letter-watermark-is-invisible-for-now/>

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### ■ **Chinese bullet train goes from 0 to 800kmph in 5 seconds**

**The Angle:** *Chinese bullet train goes from 0 to 800kmph in 5 seconds*

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.independent.co.uk/tech/china-bullet-train-acceleration-record-b3031693.html>

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## **BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)**

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### ■ ■ **Growing food under solar panels—and it actually works**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Agrovoltaic is a genuinely novel dual-use concept (food + clean energy) hitting a momentum inflection point with both research validation and real-world deployment—perfect explainer opportunity before it becomes mainstream.

**The Angle:** *Agrovoltatics sounds too good to be true: grow crops AND generate clean energy on the same land. It's moving from experimental concept to real farms, which matters as we hunt for ways to feed people and fight climate change simultaneously.*

- **Agrovoltatics** = farming food crops directly underneath or between **solar panel installations**
- Both **research validation** and **working farm examples** are spreading across regions
- The dual harvest cuts land-use pressure and scales renewable energy without sacrificing farmland

#### **The Silver Lining**

- What's the one win-win we never saw coming—and why isn't every farm doing this yet?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://yaleclimateconnections.org/2026/07/whats-the-deal-with-agrovoltatics/>

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### ■ **Russia wants to check if AI respects traditional values**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Russia testing AI against 'traditional values' for state approval is a darkly absurd geopolitical story with immediate relevance to AI regulation debates and cultural sovereignty tensions.

**The Angle:** *Russia's government is reportedly developing a certification process to test whether AI models align with 'traditional values' before they can operate in the country. It's a wild intersection of tech regulation, state ideology, and the ongoing question of who gets to define what counts as acceptable AI.*

- **Russia** is planning to test AI models against **'traditional values'** as a requirement for national approval
- The move reflects broader government control over technology sectors and ideological alignment in Russia
- This follows similar tech-regulation moves by Russia targeting Western platforms and foreign software

#### **The Absurdity Check**

- How do you even grade an AI on 'traditional values'—and who decides what those are?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://moscowmonitor.com/292/russia-to-test-ai-models-against-traditional-values-for-national-status/>

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## ■ **NASA rover just found rubies and sapphires on Mars**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): NASA finding gemstone-forming minerals on Mars is a tangible, visual discovery from an active mission that bridges science wonder with concrete geological evidence—strong storytelling hook.

***The Angle:** Perseverance just detected chromium-bearing corundum in Martian rocks—the exact mineral that forms rubies and sapphires on Earth. It's a wild reminder that Mars isn't just dust and rust; there's actual geochemistry happening that's stranger and more beautiful than we expected.*

- **Perseverance rover** found evidence of **chromium-bearing corundum** in Martian rocks
- Corundum is the mineral that forms **rubies and sapphires** on Earth
- This is the **first detection** of this gemstone-forming mineral on Mars

### **The Wonder Moment**

- If we ever colonize Mars, are we going to have a whole new gem-mining economy up there—or does knowing they're there kind of ruin the magic?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: <https://www.sciencealert.com/very-unexpected-nasa-rover-zapped-a-rock-on-mars-and-found-a-gemstone-surprise>

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## ■ **Webb telescope spots three black holes in one ancient galaxy**

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Three supermassive black holes in one galaxy is a rare astrophysical finding from JWST that challenges existing formation models and has genuine 'this changes what we thought' weight.

***The Angle:** Astronomers just caught something we didn't know was possible: three supermassive black holes hanging out together in a single galaxy from the cosmic dawn era. It's rewriting what we thought we knew about how galaxies form.*

- **James Webb Space Telescope** discovered **three active supermassive black holes** in galaxy **J0148-4214**
- The galaxy is **12.5 billion light-years away**, showing what the universe looked like **1.2 billion years after the Big Bang**
- **Two black holes** are at the galaxy's center, while a **third sits further out**

### **The Mind-Bender**

- Is the universe way more crowded with black holes than we ever thought—or are we just finally getting the tools to see what was always there?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: [https://www.aanda.org/articles/aa/full\\_html/2026/08/aa57419-25/aa57419-25.html](https://www.aanda.org/articles/aa/full_html/2026/08/aa57419-25/aa57419-25.html)

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## **FRANCHISE BANK**

**WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)**

- "'Am I Supposed to be a Comedian?': Donald Trump's Bizarre White House Correspondent's Dinner Speech Had Few Laughing" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-26)

- "Don Lemon and sexy Smurf joke make for bizarre scene, and more items from the column" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-29)

- "Phillies game forced into bizarre delay as Trea Turner's face lights up green" (nypost.com, banked 2026-08-05)

- "NYC women's shelter brings cat fights, junkies and bizarre antics to neighborhood near playground

<https://t.co/khWuUTWRRt> <https://t.co/HwXL2>" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-13)

**THROWBACK THURSDAY: 18 banked (+15 each when found)**

- "Here's How Louis Tomlinson Really Feels About These One Direction Songs on Band's 16-Year Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-24)

- "Guillermo del Toro said 'Absolutely No Goddamn AI' in 'Pan's Labyrinth' 3D Re-Release: 'We're Protecting a Lineage of Art'" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-24)

- "Shop Oprah's 'favorites' at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale, from 'ultra-flattering' pants to skin care staples" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-24)

- "'Star Trek: Starfleet Academy' Has a Troublemaking New Alien Arriving in Season 2 - Gizmodo" (Gizmodo.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-26)
  - "Apple TV's Neuromancer poster raises questions about its adaptation of an 'unfilmable' novel - Creative Bloq" (Creative Bloq (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-27)
  - "'Bold Voice of Contemporary Horror' Comic-Con Panelists Predict the Four Biggest Upcoming Trends in Genre Filmmaking" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-27)
  - "'Everybody Loves Raymond' star Patricia Heaton backs calls to ban Mayor Zohran Mamdani from 9/11 anniversary in NYC <https://t.co/UCpYAdZR5o>" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-07-29)
  - "Boy George Drops Out of 'Jesus Christ Superstar' After Pro-Israel Song Release - Rolling Stone" (Rolling Stone (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-31)
  - "'Sunday in the Park with George' Producers Confirm Summer 2027 Show Will Go On 'As Planned' After Ariana Grande Exits" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-03)
  - "Nordstrom Anniversary Sale Ends Soon — 27 Steals From Hollywood's Most-Loved Labels" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-03)
  - "Rosie O'Donnell's 'The View' reunion comments spark alumni meltdown over invites" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-08-04)
  - "Anniversary of capybaras escaping High Park inspires video game - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-05)
  - "Jake T. Austin Says He Wasn't Invited to Partake in 'Wizards of Waverly Place' Revival: 'Disappointed'" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-07)
  - "Japan commemorates 81st anniversary of the atomic bombing of Nagasaki - ctvnews.ca" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-09)
  - "Where to Watch 'Real Housewives Ultimate Girls Trip: Roaring 20th' Anniversary Series Online" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-09)
  - "Animal Justice holds one year anniversary rally at St. Joseph's Hospital" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-10)
  - "'Roseanne' Child Star Michael Fishman Slams Idea That the Show's Revival Was Unjustly Canceled: 'Words Have Consequences' - Yahoo" (PEOPLE (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-11)
  - "Lee Daniels, Nadine Labaki, Marina Abramovic Win Liberatum Pioneer Awards (Exclusive)" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-12)
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## SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- 9 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

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